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Module 7

CompTIA Security+ Exam Objectives

Domain	**Lab**
General Security Concepts	7.2
Threats, Vulnerabilities, and Mitigation	7.2, 7.3, 7.4, 7.5
Security Operations	7.1, 7.3, 7.4, 7.5

Website links change frequently. If a link in the following activities no longer works, use a search engine such as Google or Bing to search for the information.

Lab 7.1 Windows 11 Password Policy

Estimated Time: 30 minutes

Objectives

To create a more secure environment, passwords can be set to meet complexity standards to make them harder to crack. Complexity requirements add multiple guidelines to make the passwords stronger. The more complex the password is, the stronger it becomes and lessens vulnerabilities to successful attacks.

After completing this lab, you will be able to do the following:

- Identify the components of the Windows 11 password policy.
- Modify the Windows 11 password policy.

Certification Objectives

Objectives for the CompTIA Security+ exam:

- 2.5 Explain the purpose of mitigation techniques used to secure the enterprise.

- 4.6 Given a scenario, implement and maintain identity and access management.

Materials Required

This lab requires the following:

- A computer running any version of Windows 11 except Windows Home

Activity

In this lab, you configure the Windows 11 password policy.

1. Click **Start** on the taskbar, click **All apps**, and then click **Windows Tools**.
2. Double-click the **Local Security Policy** tool to open it.
3. In the left pane, expand **Account Policies** and then click **Password Policy** to display the policies in the right pane.
4. Double-click **Enforce password history**. In the Enforce password history Properties dialog box, change the **passwords remembered** setting to **15**. This setting ensures users can't reuse an old password as their new password.
5. Click **OK**.
6. Double-click **Maximum password age** in the Policy list and then change the setting to **60** days. This ensures that users change their password after 60 days.
7. Click **OK**.
8. Double-click **Minimum password age** in the Policy list and then change the setting to **2** days. This sets how many days a password must be used before the user can change it. The setting prevents users from changing their passwords immediately and enforces password history.
9. Click **OK**.
10. Double-click **Minimum password length** in the Policy list and then change the setting to **15** characters. The longer the password, the better. Twelve characters minimum should be a standard.
11. Click **OK**.

12. Double-click **Password must meet complexity requirements** in the Policy list and then click the **Enabled** option button, if necessary. By enabling this setting, the following rules will apply to passwords:

    - Passwords cannot contain the user's name or account name.
    - Passwords must contain at least 6 characters. (You already set the password length to 15.)
    - Passwords must contain at least three of the following: an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter, a number, or a special character.

13. Click **OK**.

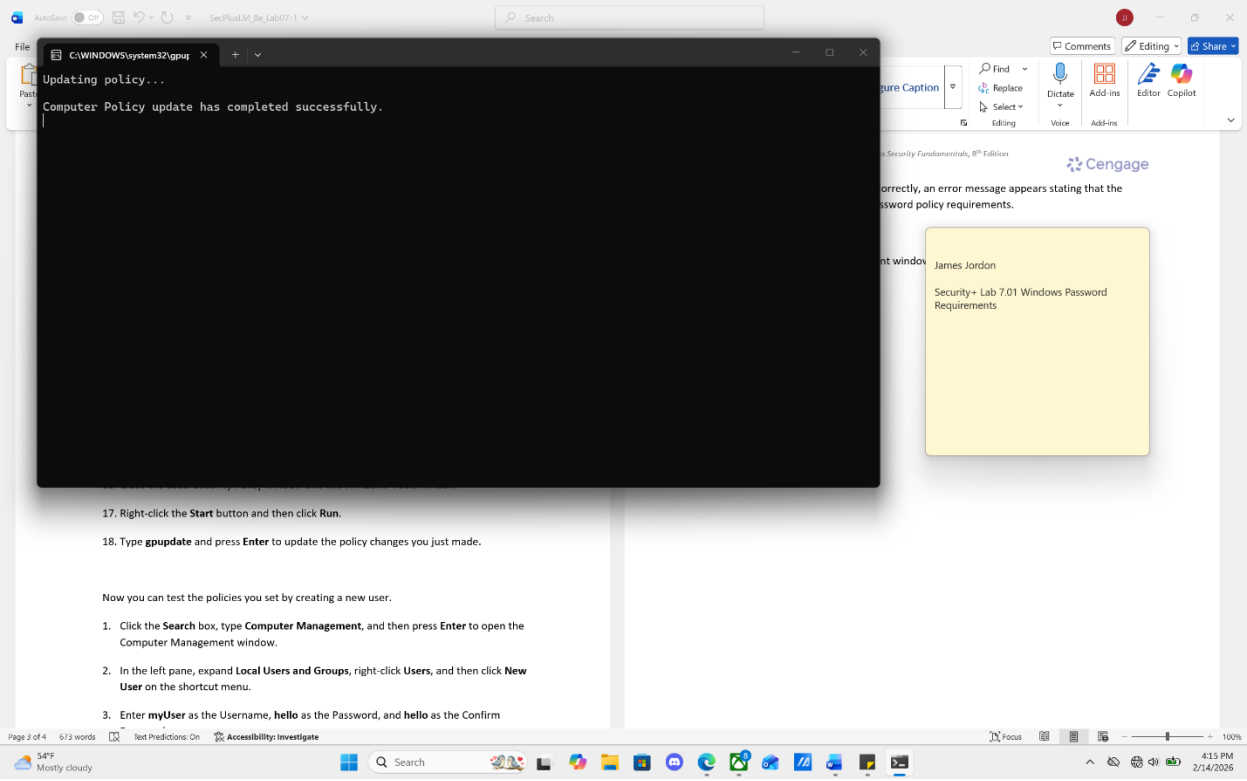
14. Double-click **Store passwords using reversible encryption** in the Policy list, and then make sure this setting is Disabled. If this setting is enabled, passwords can potentially be seen as plaintext.

15. Click **OK**.

16. Close the Local Security Policy window and the Windows Tools window.

17. Right-click the **Start** button and then click **Run**.

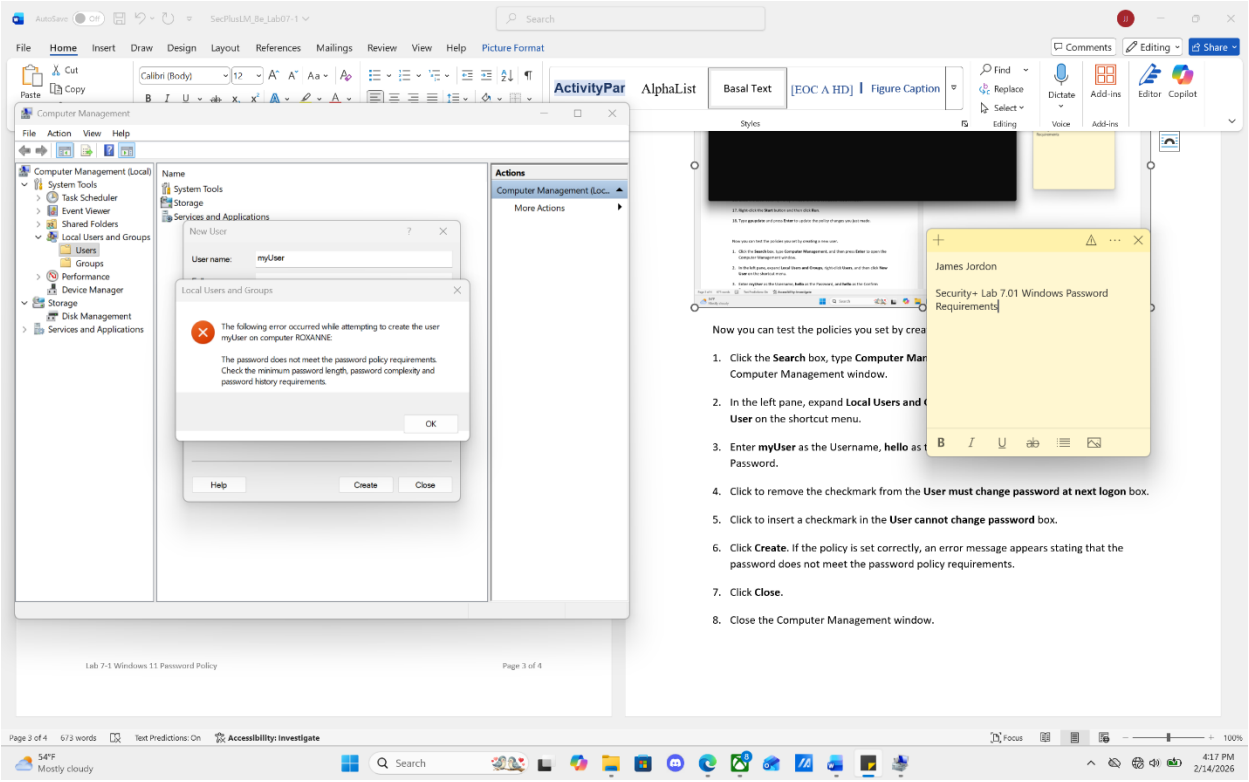
18. Type **gpupdate** and press **Enter** to update the policy changes you just made.



Now you can test the policies you set by creating a new user.

1. Click the **Search** box, type **Computer Management**, and then press **Enter** to open the Computer Management window.
2. In the left pane, expand **Local Users and Groups**, right-click **Users**, and then click **New User** on the shortcut menu.
3. Enter **myUser** as the Username, **hello** as the Password, and **hello** as the Confirm Password.
4. Click to remove the checkmark from the **User must change password at next logon** box.
5. Click to insert a checkmark in the **User cannot change password** box.

6. Click **Create**. If the policy is set correctly, an error message appears stating that the password does not meet the password policy requirements.



7. Click **Close**.

8. Close the Computer Management window.